Seasonal books and investigations

Stacie's books are the teaching texts, with hands-on access to the grade-level skills.

Week 1 | Room on the Broom

Julia Donaldson | witch, cat, dog, bird and frog props; pretend broom

Grade 3: Name a character and show how an animal helps the witch. Grade 4: Show how the animals work together to help the witch. Point to an illustration that supports your answer.

Week 2 | Big Pumpkin

Julia Donaldson | witch, cat, dog, bird and frog props; pretend broom

Grade 3: Name a character and show how an animal helps the witch. Grade 4: Show how the animals work together to help the witch. Point to an illustration that supports your answer.

Week 3 | Pumpkin Soup

Erica Silverman | pumpkin photo or small pumpkin; character cards; ribbon

Grade 3: Identify who tries to pull the pumpkin and sequence two attempts. Grade 4: Explain how the bat's idea helps the group solve the problem. Show an illustration that supports the solution.

Week 4 | Too Many Pumpkins

Helen Cooper | cat, squirrel and duck props; bowl and spoon

Grade 3: Sequence the problem and the friends' response. Grade 4: Explain how the friends' actions affect one another. Use an illustration to explain how the problem is resolved.

Week 5 | The Pumpkin Book

Linda White | pumpkin photos; garden mat; baskets

Grade 3: Show what changes for Rebecca Estelle during the story. Grade 4: Explain how her response to the pumpkins changes. Point to a scene that supports a message about sharing.

Week 6 | A Chair for My Mother

Linda White | pumpkin photos; garden mat; baskets

Grade 3: Show what changes for Rebecca Estelle during the story. Grade 4: Explain how her response to the pumpkins changes. Point to a scene that supports a message about sharing.

Informational reading

The Pumpkin Book by Gail Gibbons replaces the former flag book in weeks 1-2. Identify the central idea, find a real growth fact and connect the fact to the idea. Keep this informational strand alongside Room on the Broom.

2026-10-23 | Science investigation

Pumpkin push investigation: use a lightweight pumpkin model on a tray. Grade 3 predicts and compares a push and pull (3.7B). Grade 4 rolls a toy car into the stationary model and observes energy transfer (4.8A). Repeat three trials with the same surface. Save one prediction, observation and explanation per learner.

2026-11-06 | Science investigation

Pumpkin sound investigation: shake an adult-sealed container of dried pumpkin seeds softly. Grade 3 identifies sound energy (3.8A). Grade 4 compares sound on/off beside a light paper membrane to look for vibration as evidence of sound energy transfer (4.8A). If no movement is visible, record that result and use the teacher's tested sound demonstration.

2026-11-20 | Science investigation

Leaf-and-ramp investigation: first observe and sort collected leaves by visible features as ungraded exploration. Test the same toy car on a bare ramp and a securely fixed dry-leaf surface. Grade 3 compares speed and the distance a foam block moves after contact (3.8B); Grade 4 describes the friction pattern (4.7). Keep car, release point and ramp height constant; repeat three trials. Do not infer energy from leaf color. Grade 3 uses the same car and foam block for slow/faster trials, resets the block each time and compares the effects. Grade 4 changes only the track surface for the friction comparison.

2026-12-11 | Science investigation

Design-and-test lab: reuse the familiar ramp setup. Grade 3 demonstrates a motion/energy finding (3.8B). Grade 4 tests smooth and textured surfaces for a friction pattern (4.7). Make one planned change, repeat three times, and use a photo or model to explain the evidence. Grade 3 uses the same car and foam block for slow/faster trials, resets the block each time and compares the effects. Grade 4 changes only the track surface for the friction comparison.

Access and evidence

Props, pictures and AAC support the response. Return to the actual book or investigation evidence. Record accuracy and prompts separately; use three observations on lab Fridays.